

Chapter 14-1

Until she hung up the phone, Liang Shi hadn't really come back to her senses.

She couldn't even remember how she had brushed off Mrs. Liang and ended the call.

However, she still changed her ringtone after hanging up.

It was too jarring.

If someone called while she was sleeping, she'd probably be scared to death.

After changing the ringtone, Liang Shi went through the original body's phone thoroughly—memos, cloud storage, shopping apps, WeChat contacts, Weibo—she searched everything from top to bottom.

The original body's memo app only had three entries:

【Run away, run far away.】

【Sacrifice. Hah.】

【Who would be a good child? Death.】

Three inexplicable sentences that didn't connect to each other at all.

Each entry was dated on the 15th day of the 7th lunar month¹, but in different years.

The first one was from 2019.

The second one was from 2020.

The third one was from 2021.

And now it was already 2023.

This phone had been with the original body for quite some years.

The date of the 15th day of the 7th lunar month was strange—everyone knew it was the Ghost Festival², the day when legend said the gates of hell opened wide.

Liang Shi hadn't been superstitious about these things before, but now that she had transmigrated into a book and encountered a system, her life was already this bizarre. Adding some other even more bizarre things seemed... not impossible?

Most importantly, sacrifice was mentioned.

Sacrifice to whom? What were the sacrificial items?

She didn't understand.

The original body had a particularly bad habit of almost never adding notes for people. Apart from family members, there was no one else in her contacts, but her text message list had many messages from unknown numbers, like the one she'd seen before about "swapping wives."

She was completely confused and had no idea who these people were.

The original body's notes for family members were all very brief, basically using just one character.

Only Xu Qingzhu's was somewhat special—her note was "Bamboo."

There was even a tree emoji that came with the phone.

From these small details, it seemed like the original body really did like Xu Qingzhu?

This kind of behavior seemed like something only little girls in the throes of love would do.

But if she liked Xu Qingzhu and had already married her, why couldn't she be open and honest about it?

This was very puzzling.

Maybe because Xu Qingzhu wouldn't let her touch her?

But Liang Shi remembered the book had explained this part—because Xu Qingzhu had been kidnapped and left with post-traumatic stress disorder, she was very afraid of intimate contact with people. On their wedding night, the drunk Alpha tried to assault her, causing Xu Qingzhu to be hospitalized on their wedding night.

And that night, the intoxicated Alpha had relations with a Beta.

They were all cannon fodder characters, so the book didn't even give them names.

But when the sober Xu Qingzhu learned about this, she never let her touch her again.

Their relationship became very strained.

To trick Xu Qingzhu into bed, the original body had tried many methods, but they all came to nothing. Finally, on the suggestion of her bad friends, she chose the method of pheromone suppression.

At the time, that friend said, "Omegas, once you mark them, they become obedient."

"After the first time, they'll beg you to touch them."

The original body was promiscuous and had many bad friends. She was in dozens of WeChat groups, flirting and being inappropriate in every one.

Some groups had only Alphas, so all the conversations were about Omegas—who went to which club today, what kind of girls they picked up, how they felt, what new tricks they played in bed, and some people even sent explicit pictures.

Liang Shi clicked in and scrolled through quite a bit, then chose to clear the chat history and leave the groups.

She left more than a dozen in a row.

There were also groups with Omegas and Betas together, where everyone chatted nonsense, basically all skirting the edge of propriety.

Some Omegas used swimsuit photos or maid costume photos as their avatars.

Liang Shi wondered—hadn't the country's anti-pornography campaigns reached here?

Even in an ABO world, there should still be a complete social system.

Novel authors basically set their backgrounds based on the real world, so many aspects were similar to the world Liang Shi originally lived in, except for the genders and privileges unique to the ABO world.

Plus the addition of rapid civilization development, declining birth rates, and regulations prohibiting abortion in this world.

Liang Shi frowned and repeated the previous operation.

She left over eighty groups in a row, and her WeChat exploded again.

A bunch of people came to ask what had happened and why she suddenly left the groups. Looking at those people without notes, she fell into contemplation.

Should she... delete them too?

Liang Shi thought about it and decided against it.

However, she did delete those Omegas and Betas who were obviously just for flirting and inappropriate behavior.

This was her account, and she didn't want to see that kind of filth.

Even opening her Moments³, it was full of photos that were almost like nude shots.

Quite... eye-searing.

Liang Shi also went through Weibo and found that the original body had never posted on Weibo, and her browsing history was quite clean, so she apparently didn't use this app much.

The cloud storage situation wasn't good.

She had a cloud storage membership with 1TB of capacity, basically filled with small videos.

Liang Shi had watched such videos out of curiosity before, but they were all very normal, aesthetic segments.

But when she clicked on one of the original body's stored videos and watched the beginning, she almost threw up. It was extremely hardcore, full of blood and violence.

Liang Shi immediately closed it and cleared out everything in the cloud storage all at once.

For a moment, she felt like she was wiping an account clean.

Erasing the traces of that person's life, then replacing everything with herself.

But she was the one who had to continue living from now on.

By the time she finished all this, it was already 1 AM. Mentally exhausted to the extreme, Liang Shi lay there but couldn't fall asleep.

There were too many uncertainties in life, and the completely unfamiliar environment kept her mind highly tense, causing some insomnia.

She lay there with her thoughts wandering for a long time, and in the end didn't know how she fell asleep.

When she woke up early the next morning, the hospital room was empty.

She went downstairs to check on Xu Qingzhu, who was still asleep, so she went outside the hospital to eat breakfast.

After eating, she returned to the hospital room to sleep.

Nurses came and went in the hospital room, but Liang Shi didn't notice.

She was too tired and desperately needed rest.

Footnotes:

¹ **15th day of the 7th lunar month (農曆七月十五日):** This date corresponds to the Ghost Festival in Chinese culture, when it's believed that the boundary between the living and dead worlds is thinnest.

² **Ghost Festival (中元節):** Also known as the Hungry Ghost Festival, a traditional Chinese festival when it's believed that deceased ancestors visit the living, and the gates of hell open to let ghosts roam the earth.

³ **Moments (朋友圈):** WeChat's social media feature, similar to Facebook's timeline, where users can post photos and updates for their contacts to see.

Chapter 14-2

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Liang Shi slept for a day and a half, finally restoring her energy.

She handled her own discharge procedures and drove the car to the 4S shop¹ to exchange it for a white Porsche.

When she returned to the hospital, it was already afternoon.

She went up to the tenth floor, to Xu Qingzhu's hospital room. Standing at the door, she heard cheerful laughter.

She hesitated about whether to go in, but heard Zhao Xuning behind her say, "If you're going in, go in. If not, don't block the way."

Liang Shi: "..."

She pushed open the door and went in. The cheerful laughter in the room came to an abrupt halt.

Bai Weiwei rolled her eyes when she saw her and said sarcastically, "Oh my, Second Miss Liang is here. Aren't you afraid this place will dirty your shoes?"

Liang Shi didn't respond, only looked toward Xu Qingzhu and asked gently, "Are you feeling better?"

Xu Qingzhu nodded and gave a cold "mm" in response.

"There's no time like the present," Bai Weiwei said, "Why not right now? The civil affairs bureau² isn't closed yet. You two should go get your divorce certificate."

Liang Shi immediately said, "Who says we're getting divorced?"

"Second Miss Liang, if you don't want a divorce, then we'll see you in court," Bai Weiwei stood up to confront her, "Our Bamboo³ isn't someone to be bullied. I've consulted with a lawyer—even within marriage, forcing an Omega to have sex and forcibly marking an Omega are both illegal."

Liang Shi: "..."

But she wasn't the one who did that.

But who told the original body to commit such sins?

"I have no such intention," Liang Shi explained.

Bai Weiwei snorted coldly.

Liang Shi's phone vibrated slightly. She took it out to look—it was a voice message from Qiu Zimin.

She clicked to convert it to text, but accidentally hit play instead.

Qiu Zimin's voice rang out in the hospital room: "Tonight at 7:30 at Cangyue Restaurant, don't be late. Even if you've changed your mind, you need to go tell Zhou Yi'an yourself. I won't..."

Liang Shi frantically kept pressing the wrong button, and finally managed to hit pause.

But everyone had heard what they needed to hear.

Everyone in the hospital room looked unpleasant.

Liang Shi immediately said, "Xu Qingzhu, I can explain."

But Xu Qingzhu lay down and pulled the covers over herself, her voice very light: "Please leave. I'm tired."

Liang Shi: "..."

At this rate, she'd never get 80 luck points even in her next lifetime!

Footnotes:

¹ **4S shop (4S店)**: In China, these are comprehensive automotive service shops that provide Sales, Spares (parts), Service, and Survey (customer feedback). They're typically authorized dealers for specific car brands.

² **Civil affairs bureau (民政局)**: The government office in China responsible for civil matters including marriage registration and divorce procedures.

³ **Bamboo (竹子)**: Bai Weiwei's nickname for Xu Qingzhu, playing on the "zhu" (竹) character in her name which means bamboo.